STORYBOARD AI

Product Brief & Build Package

Revised Edition

A screenplay-to-storyboard workspace for directorial clarity.

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1. Product Principle

Product Name (working): Storyboard AI

Category: Screenplay-to-storyboard workspace for agencies and filmmakers.

Positioning: Turn your screenplay into an editable, cinematic storyboard in minutes.

This is a storyboarding workspace with AI assistance, not an AI generator with workflow wrapped around it. The product sells directorial clarity, not images.

Product Thesis

The input text is not the product. The images are not the product. The product is structured cinematic interpretation with controllable visual output. The system generates three artifacts per project:

1. Scene map — what happens in the story
2. Shot plan — how to show it cinematically
3. Storyboard panels — what it looks like, with continuity

If any layer is missing, the app degrades into either a text parser or an inconsistent image generator.

Governing Principles

Three hard defenses that govern all V1 decisions:

> ***1. Render is downstream of decision-making, not where decision-making happens.***
>
> ***2. Design and workflow integrity take precedence over generation breadth. If a feature increases output volume but reduces user understanding, edit safety, continuity trust, or presentation quality, it does not qualify for V1.***
>
> ***3. Do not scale beyond one scene until trust metrics pass.***

Naming Discipline

Use these terms in all product, marketing, and internal communications:

- Storyboard workspace (not “AI storyboard generator”)
- Directorial workflow (not “AI art tool”)
- Screenplay-to-storyboard platform (not “content generator”)

“Generator” language attracts the wrong buyer and weakens pricing power.

2. Confidence & Control Principle

For every scene, the product must show:

- What the system parsed confidently
- What it inferred (and the confidence level of that inference)
- What needs user confirmation before render budget is spent
- What is locked versus still flexible

> ***The system must help users spend render budget deliberately, not discover structure through rendering.***

Three Explicit Scene States

Each scene maintains three distinct states. When output is wrong, the team must be able to identify whether the problem originated in parsing, directing, or rendering:

State	Contains	Editable By
Parsed Scene State	What the script says: scenes, beats, characters, locations, props, tone, sluglines, dialogue	System (auto) + user (manual fix for malformed scripts)
Directed Scene State	What shots we decided to use: shot type, framing, angle, camera intent, rationale, continuity notes, approval status	System (recommendations) + user (approve, edit, add, delete, split, merge, pin)
Rendered Scene State	What visuals were produced: panels, metadata, variant history, continuity locks	System (render) + user (regen, reorder, pin as anchor)

When a user edits a shot, the system updates Directed State. When continuity breaks, the system inspects state rather than blindly regenerating. The product must preserve structured story, shot, approval, and continuity state separately so users can inspect, edit, and regenerate locally without collapsing the scene.

3. V1 Goals

V1 Gate Statement

> ***V1 is successful only if one scene can be parsed, approved, rendered, locally revised, and exported with user trust intact.***

V1 Outcomes

- Users get to a usable first storyboard fast (target: under 10 minutes for a short script)
- Screenplay health is visible before generation begins
- Shot plan is inspectable and approvable before rendering
- Every panel has a visible rationale — users understand why the system chose each shot
- Users can revise individual panels without damaging neighbors (local, non-destructive revision)
- Continuity state is visible at all times
- Output is client-safe enough to export and share

V1 Acceptance Criteria

V1 is complete when all of the following are true:

1. Screenplay health is visible before generation
2. Shot plan is inspectable before rendering
3. Rendering happens only from an approved shot plan
4. One panel can be revised without damaging neighboring panels
5. Continuity state is visible on every panel
6. Export is client-safe

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4. Core V1 Requirements

4.1 Screenplay Input & Parse Confidence

- Screenplay paste or upload
- Screenplay format health check (detect malformed sluglines, dialogue blocks, missing scene headers)
- Scene-level parse confidence score
- Warnings for low-confidence parses with manual fix flow before generation proceeds
- Auto scene detection, beat extraction, character/location/prop identification

If ingest is shaky, the entire directorial clarity promise collapses.

4.2 Shot Plan Generation & Approval Gate

The system must not jump from parse to render without a clear approval checkpoint:

- AI-generated shot list with type, framing, angle, camera intent, rationale, and continuity notes
- Shot-plan approval mode: approve all, approve individually, or edit before render
- Lock individual shots before render (locked shots skip re-recommendation on rerun)
- Render only after plan sign-off — rendering from an unapproved plan is not permitted in V1

4.3 Human Override Controls

These are not optional editing conveniences. They are what separates software from hopeful prompting:

- Add a shot manually to the plan
- Delete a shot from the plan
- Split a beat into multiple shots
- Merge adjacent shots
- Pin a panel as a continuity anchor (subsequent renders inherit its visual state)
- Change shot type on any panel and re-render
- Reorder panels within a scene via drag-and-drop

4.4 Storyboard Rendering

- Render storyboard panels from an approved shot plan (not directly from raw text)
- Project-level style lock (set once at project creation, applied consistently)
- Per-panel regeneration with neighbor preservation
- Continuity state inherited from adjacent panels and pinned anchors

4.5 Output & Export

- PDF export with layout options (title page, panel density, notes on/off)
- Client-safe export mode (clean presentation, no internal metadata clutter)

4.6 Error-State Design

The product must clearly explain failures. If it only looks smart when it succeeds, it is not production-ready:

Error Condition	Required UX Response
Malformed screenplay structure	Show specific parse errors, highlight affected lines, provide manual fix flow before generation proceeds

Low parse confidence on a scene	Display confidence indicator; warn user to review before approving shot plan; suggest areas to check
Weak continuity confidence	Show continuity badge as “at risk”; identify which elements (character, location, prop) are uncertain
Render mismatch vs shot type	Flag panel as mismatched; show expected shot type vs actual render characteristics; offer one-click regen with stronger constraints
Failed panel regeneration	Preserve previous panel version; explain failure reason; offer fallback options (simpler style, different angle, manual override)

4.7 Full V1 Feature Scope

Feature	Description	Classification
Screenplay input	Paste or upload screenplay text	Core V1 Requirement
Parse confidence & health check	Format validation, scene-level confidence, malformed-script warnings	Core V1 Requirement
Scene/beat extraction	Auto-parse scenes, beats, characters, locations, tone	Core V1 Requirement
Shot plan generation	AI shot list with type, framing, rationale, continuity notes	Core V1 Requirement
Shot-plan approval gate	Approve/edit/lock shots before any rendering occurs	Core V1 Requirement
Human override controls	Add, delete, split, merge shots; pin continuity anchors	Core V1 Requirement
Project-level style lock	Visual style chosen once at project creation	Core V1 Requirement
Storyboard rendering from approved plan	Panels rendered from approved shot specs + style + continuity	Core V1 Requirement
Per-panel local, non-destructive revision	Regen one panel without affecting neighbors	Core V1 Requirement
Panel reordering	Drag to reorder within a scene	Core V1 Requirement
Grounding cards	Character, location, and prop reference cards with visual + descriptive traits	Core V1 Requirement
Error-state UX	Clear handling for bad parse, low confidence, render mismatch, failed regen	Core V1 Requirement
Continuity visibility	Continuity state (locked / at risk / changed) visible on every panel	Core V1 Requirement

Three-pane workspace	Script + shot plan + storyboard canvas as core product surface	Core V1 Requirement
PDF export (client-safe)	Presentable export with layout options	Core V1 Requirement
Continuity lock improvements	Stronger character/location memory	P1 (post-V1)
Panel notes & review states	Per-panel notes, approval status	P1 (post-V1)
Enhanced exports	Branded themes, title pages, shareable review links	P1 (post-V1)
Collaboration-lite	Read-only review links, comment pins, scene approval status	P1.5 (post-V1)
Prose input	Freeform story/narrative text	P2 (later-stage)
Full collaboration	Multi-user editing, approval workflows	P2 (later-stage)
Animatics	Timeline-based panel sequencing with timing	P2 (later-stage)
API / integrations	Plugin ecosystem, external tool connections	P2 (later-stage)

5. Core UX Requirement: Three-Pane Workspace

The three-pane workspace is a core product requirement, not a layout preference. It is part of V1 scope, alpha validation, and product differentiation. The workspace is how the product explains itself.

Pane	Content	Purpose	Key Elements
Left	Script / Scene Navigator + Parse Health	Show source material, scene structure, and parse confidence	Scene list, parsing status, confidence indicators, character/location detection, malformed-script warnings
Center	Shot Planner + Approval State	Display directorial decisions, rationale, and approval controls	Beat cards, shot list, rationale, shot type, approval state (approved / pending / edited), override controls
Right	Storyboard Canvas + Continuity + Variants	Show rendered panels with trust metadata	Panel grid, continuity badge, regen controls,

			variant compare, reorder, pinned anchors

Panel Metadata (Trust Layer)

Every panel must display inspectable metadata. Hidden logic is unacceptable:

- Source scene and source beat
- Shot type and camera angle
- Purpose / intent of the shot
- Approval status of the underlying shot spec
- Continuity state (locked / at risk / changed by regen)
- Continuity assumptions currently locked
- What changed on the last regen
- Rationale for the shot selection
- Regenerate and edit controls

UX Acceptance Gate

A first-time user must be able to identify, within seconds and without explanation:

1. The current scene
2. The approved shot plan
3. The active panel
4. The continuity state
5. The next safe action

If they cannot, the workflow is not ready for alpha.

Five Experience States

The user moves through five states. If the progression feels unclear, the product feels random:

#	State	User Action	System Response
1	Ingest	Paste or upload screenplay	Accept, parse, show health check and confidence
2	Understand	Review detected scenes, beats, and entities	Show parsed structure with confidence indicators
3	Direct	Inspect, approve, and edit the shot plan	Display shot list with rationale, approval controls, and overrides
4	Visualize	Review rendered storyboard panels	Render panels from approved plan with continuity and metadata

5	Present	Export or share the board	Generate client-safe PDF or review link

Golden Path (V1 User Flow)

1. Create a new project
2. Choose visual style once at project creation (project-level style lock)
3. Upload or paste screenplay
4. Review parse health check and confidence indicators
5. Fix any malformed sections flagged by the parser
6. Select a scene to work on
7. Inspect the AI-generated shot list and rationale
8. Approve the shot plan (approve all, edit individual shots, or lock specific shots)
9. Generate storyboard panels from the approved plan
10. Tweak individual shots or regenerate specific panels as needed
11. Export the storyboard as a client-safe PDF

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6. Grounding Cards & Auditability

6.1 Grounding Cards

Continuity cannot remain backend mythology. Users need visible, editable reference for recurring visual elements:

Card Type	Contents	User Controls
Character Card	Visual reference, physical traits, wardrobe, key features, continuity notes	Edit descriptive traits, upload reference image, adjust lock strength / confidence
Location Card	Visual reference, spatial layout, key environmental features, lighting/time-of-day	Edit traits, upload reference, set lighting/time defaults
Prop Card	Visual reference, size/shape, relationship to characters, continuity notes	Edit traits, upload reference, pin to specific scenes

Grounding cards feed into the continuity state and rendering pipeline. Panels rendered without grounding card context will have weaker continuity — the system should surface this as a confidence indicator.

6.2 Panel Auditability

For every panel, the system must be able to answer:

- Which scene it came from
- Which beat it represents
- Which approved shot spec drove it
- What grounding cards were referenced
- What changed on the last regen
- What continuity assumptions are currently locked

This is how trust is debugged. It is also how the product is sold to professionals.

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7. Validation Metrics

Activation

- Primary activation metric: user exports a storyboard within first session
- Funnel: screenplay uploaded → parse reviewed → shot plan approved → scene rendered → board exported

Product Quality

- Percentage of panels accepted without regeneration
- Average regenerations per scene (lower is better)
- Shot-plan approval score from target users
- Continuity failure rate per scene
- Percentage of edits resolved with local rerun only
- Percentage of panels that remain valid after a local edit to a neighboring panel (primary technical KPI)
- Percentage of scenes approved before rendering
- Time from shot-plan approval to first export
- Percentage of exports with zero manual panel deletions
- Variant compare usage rate

Retention

- 7-day return rate
- Second project started; second export completed
- Percentage of returning users who bring a new script

Revenue

- Free-to-paid conversion rate after first export
- Average renders per paid project
- Cost per successfully exported project
- Team-seat expansion rate for agency accounts

8. Pricing Hypotheses (Experiments, Not Fixed Truth)

Pricing Philosophy

Sell workflow value; meter render cost. The expensive part is rendering. The valuable part is directorial acceleration. Do not offer unlimited generation at a flat subscription rate.

Hypothesis A: Subscription + Credits

Feature	Free	Pro	Team / Studio	Add-Ons
Projects	1	Unlimited	Unlimited	—
Panels / month	Capped (low)	Monthly credit allotment	Higher credit pool	Extra credit packs
Watermark	Yes	No	No	—
Style presets	Basic	Full library	Full + brand kits	Alt-style passes
Export	Basic PDF	Standard PDF	Branded + themes	High-res export
Seats	1	1	Multiple	—
Shared workspaces	—	—	Yes	—
Review workflow	—	—	Yes	—
Continuity controls	Basic	Standard	Premium	Premium mode

Hypothesis B: Scene-First Billing

Price around deliverable units users naturally think in: projects, scenes, and render passes rather than abstract panel math. Worth testing against Hypothesis A, especially for agencies who think in deliverables.

- Project limits per tier
- Scene generation credits
- Premium render passes per scene

Hypothesis C: Output Tiers

Not every user needs expensive high-fidelity panels immediately. Tiered output helps margins and speed:

Tier	Output Quality	Use Case
Rough thumbnails	Fast, low-cost sketches; basic framing and composition	Internal ideation, quick iteration, draft review
Presentation boards	Polished panels suitable for client meetings	Pitch decks, client reviews, stakeholder presentations
Premium continuity mode	Highest fidelity with strongest character/location/prop consistency	Final production boards, high-stakes presentations

Premium Margin Drivers

Extra generations are commodity. The real margin lives in presentation power and control:

- Branded export themes and title pages
- Shareable review links and client-safe presentation mode
- Side-by-side version comparison for alternate panels
- Premium continuity lock controls
- Shot rationale visibility in exported documents

9. Ideal Customer Profile (ICP)

9.1 Primary Buyer: Agencies & Creative Teams

Attribute	Detail
Who	Creative directors, producers, account leads at advertising agencies, production companies, and brand creative teams
Core Pain	Need client-facing storyboards fast; current process requires manual shot planning or expensive artists with multi-day turnarounds

Buying Signal	Speed and presentation quality; willingness to pay for tools that reduce turnaround from days to minutes
ACV Potential	High — team seats, branded exports, volume usage
Tolerance for AI	High, provided output is editable and presentable

9.2 Primary Design Partner: Indie Filmmakers & Directors

Attribute	Detail
Who	Independent directors, storyboard-heavy creators, and pre-visualization specialists
Core Pain	Already think in scenes and shots; need affordable previsualization without a full storyboard artist
Value to Product	Most specific and useful feedback on shot logic and continuity; strong case-study potential; keep the product honest
ACV Potential	Moderate — individual Pro subscriptions

9.3 Deprioritized Segments

- Hobby writers / casual creators — weak storyboard need, low willingness to pay
- AI art enthusiasts — generation novelty interest pulls product toward gimmick territory
- Content creators / YouTubers — good scale later, but drags positioning if targeted too early
- Screenwriters (standalone) — weaker initial buyer; viable later as pitch enhancement

10. Technical Architecture

10.1 Pipeline

The system is a stateful pipeline. Each stage produces structured, inspectable output. Edits trigger localized reruns, not full-project regeneration.

Stage	Action	Input	Output	User Checkpoint
1. Ingest	Parse screenplay	Raw screenplay text	Scenes, dialogue, action, entities, tone	Review parse health + confidence
2. Interpret	Extract beats	Parsed scenes	Beats with intent, emotion, action	Review beat structure

			level, continuity reqs	
3. Direct	Generate shot plan	Tagged beats	Shot list with type, framing, rationale, continuity notes	Approve shot plan (gate)
4. Visualize	Render panels	Approved shots + style + continuity + grounding cards	Panels with metadata	Review, regen, reorder
5. Edit Loop	Handle revisions	User changes	Only affected nodes re-run	Verify local, non-destructive result

10.2 Core Data Objects

Object	Role
Project	Top-level container; owns all other objects
Script	Raw screenplay text and parsing state
Scene	Discrete unit of action at one location/time
Beat	Meaningful moment within a scene
Shot	Cinematic recommendation for how to show a beat
Panel	Rendered visual for a shot, with metadata
Style Profile	Visual style parameters applied project-wide
Continuity State	Persistent memory of character, location, prop, and lighting consistency
Character Card	Visual + descriptive reference for a recurring character
Location Card	Visual + descriptive reference for a recurring location
Prop Card	Visual + descriptive reference for a recurring prop
Approval State	Per-shot and per-scene approval status (pending / approved / edited)
Confidence State	Per-scene parse confidence and per-panel continuity confidence
Variant History	Previous versions of regenerated panels for comparison and rollback

10.3 Primary Technical Risk: Control Drift

The primary risk is not image quality — it is control drift: shot specs not matching rendered output, characters mutating, locations shifting, tone inconsistency, and regen breaking neighbors.

Mitigation: strict state chain (story state → shot state → render state) with persistent project memory. Edits propagate downward. Re-renders inherit continuity context from adjacent panels and pinned anchors.

10.4 Primary Technical KPI

> ***Percentage of panels that remain valid after a local edit to a neighboring panel.***

This measures whether the product is genuinely stateful and controlled, or faking it with lucky generations.

10.5 Future-Proofing Note

There is a strong B2B white-label and API-adjacent future for agencies, production houses, script tools, and previsualization workflows. V1 decisions should avoid trapping data in opaque prompt blobs. Structured scene, shot, approval, and continuity data must remain exportable and inspectable — not just for user trust, but for future integration value.

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11. Execution Roadmap

Single-Scene Gate

> ***Do not move to full-script breadth until one scene passes all four: interpretation works, workspace is self-explanatory, edits are safe, export is credible.***

The first milestone is not “supports full screenplay.” It is: one scene in, one trustworthy storyboard sequence out.

Stage 1: Prove the Brain

Goal: Verify the system can make sane cinematic decisions for a single scene.

Build

- Screenplay ingest with parse confidence and health check
- Scene parsing and beat extraction
- Shot recommendation engine with rationale
- Shot-plan approval gate
- One-scene storyboard render from approved plan
- Per-panel regen with neighbor preservation
- Project-level style lock
- Grounding cards (character, location, prop)

Exit Criteria

- 3–5 real scripts processed end-to-end for at least one scene
- Shot plans rated “useful” by at least 3 target users
- Per-panel regen preserves neighboring continuity reliably
- Parse confidence indicators are accurate and trusted by users
- First-scene output is presentable

Stage 2: Prove the Workflow

Goal: Confirm users can work inside the tool end-to-end.

Build

- Three-pane workspace with parse health, shot approval state, and continuity badges
- Editable shot list with full override controls (add, delete, split, merge, pin)
- Panel reorder, shot-type editing, variant comparison
- Panel metadata visibility (full trust layer)
- Error-state UX for all failure modes
- PDF export (client-safe)

Exit Criteria

- Users go from screenplay to exported board without handholding
- Edits feel local, not destructive
- Users understand why each panel exists
- At least 50% of alpha users export something in session one
- Error states are clear and actionable

Stage 3: Prove the Business

Goal: Validate willingness to pay and sustainable economics.

Build

- Project persistence and storage
- Usage tracking and billing infrastructure
- Pricing experiment A (subscription + credits) and B (scene-first billing)
- Output tier experiment (rough / presentation / premium continuity)
- Cleaner presentation and branded export modes

Exit Criteria

- Multiple users ask to keep using the product after trial ends
- Paid beta users tolerate usage-based limits
- Export/share behavior repeats across multiple projects
- Unit economics (cost per exported project) are survivable

Stage 4: Scale Features (Post-Validation Only)

- Prose / freeform story input
- Full collaboration (multi-user editing, approval workflows)
- Animatic timeline
- Style kits and brand templates
- API and plugin integrations

12. Risk Register

#	Risk	Symptom	Mitigation	Detection
1	Generic shot logic	Boards feel like random film-school clichés	Human-reviewed heuristics; genre presets; explicit rationale per shot; design-partner feedback	Shot-plan approval scores from alpha users
2	Continuity breaks on regen	Characters, props, settings mutate across panels	Persistent continuity state; scene memory; localized reruns; grounding cards; pinned anchors	Continuity failure rate; % panels valid after neighbor edit
3	Users don't trust the system	No visible logic behind choices	Full panel metadata; confidence indicators; approval gate before render	UX acceptance gate testing; user interviews
4	Pretty but not useful	Users say "cool" but not "I'd use this"	Recruit agencies/directors early; optimize for exportability and review workflow	Export rate; "real project" survey responses
5	Cost structure collapses	Render usage destroys margins	Subscription + credits; output tiers; optimize regen locality; approval gate reduces wasted renders	Cost per exported project; render/panel ratio
6	Scope creep	Prose, collab, animatics attempted too early	Screenplay-only V1; feature review filter; go/no-go gates	Feature review process adherence
7	Overly literal interpretation	Renders exactly what text says, no cinematic intent	Direction layer adds cinematic intent; genre presets;	Director feedback on shot appropriateness

			camera language presets	
8	Messy screenplay input	Bad parses cascade into nonsensical shot plans	Parse health check; confidence indicators; manual fix flow before generation; error-state UX	Parse confidence accuracy; fix-flow completion rate

13. Go / No-Go Gates

Do not expand to full-script breadth, prose input, collaboration, or animatics until all five conditions are met:

Gate	Condition	Validation Method
1	Shot plans are respected by real target users (agencies and directors)	User interviews + approval scoring
2	Scene continuity survives panel edits without cascading failures	Automated continuity tests + panel-validity-after-neighbor-edit metric
3	Users export storyboards without coaching or hand-holding	Funnel analytics: paste-to-export completion rate
4	At least some users say they would use this on real production work	Post-session surveys + repeat-project tracking
5	Unit economics are survivable (cost per exported project within margin targets)	Cost accounting per project; render efficiency tracking

14. Governance & Review Filters

14.1 V1 Feature Review Test

Any proposed V1 feature must earn three things simultaneously:

1. A clearer decision for the user
2. A safer edit path
3. A more trustworthy output

If it only adds capability but not clarity, control, or trust, it is not V1 work. It is backlog.

14.2 Combined Review Checklist

Before a feature is accepted into V1, ask:

- Product: What user outcome does this improve?
- Design: What becomes clearer on screen?
- Workflow: What becomes safer or more local to edit?
- Trust: Does this reduce ambiguity before or after render?
- Business: Does this help export success, retention, or cost discipline?

If the answers are weak, cut it.

14.3 Design Review Filter

Any V1 feature proposal must also state what becomes clearer on screen. If the answer is nothing, it is backend vanity, not user value. Design-side checks:

- Does it make the current scene clearer?
- Does it make the shot-to-panel relationship clearer?
- Does it make safe editing clearer?
- Does it make export more client-safe?

14.4 Feature Classification Rule

Every item in the brief must carry one of three labels:

Label	Meaning
Core V1 Requirement	Must be built and working before alpha. Non-negotiable.
Validation Metric	Must be measurable. Used to decide go/no-go gates.
Pricing Experiment	Must be tested, not assumed true. Multiple hypotheses are expected.

If requirements and hypotheses are mixed, the team will build experiments as if they were truths. That is how scope rot starts.

15. Non-Goals & Later-Stage Expansion

These are explicitly outside V1 scope. Nothing keeps a product sharp like saying no early:

Item	Why Not V1

Prose / freeform story input	Separate parsing problem; dilutes V1 accuracy; attempting both screenplay and freeform in V1 fragments quality
Full collaboration	Adds complexity before core loop is validated; collaboration-lite (review links, comments) is a P1.5 candidate
Animatics / video generation	Seductive scope trap; requires timeline infrastructure that distracts from single-scene trust
Style marketplace / library expansion	Not until project-level style lock actually works reliably
Mobile-first app	Three-pane workspace is a desktop-first workflow; mobile is absurd for this use case
Community templates	Worthless before core trust is proven; premature community features attract wrong users
Voice / audio generation	Different product category entirely
Full character design studio	Grounding cards handle the V1 need; full design tooling is scope creep
API / integrations	Valuable future lane, but V1 must prove the core loop first

16. Competitive Moat

Image generation is commodity. The defensible differentiation is:

Moat Layer	Why It Matters
Screenplay parsing with confidence	Accurate extraction with visible health check and confidence indicators — not blind optimism
Beat-to-shot intelligence	Cinematic recommendations that feel directed: pacing, tension, camera language, genre awareness
Approval-gated rendering	Users control when render budget is spent; decisions are inspectable before rendering begins
Continuity memory + grounding cards	Persistent state with visible, editable character/location/prop references
Local, non-destructive revision	Edit one panel safely; the system is genuinely stateful, not faking it
Production-grade workflow	Three-pane workspace, trust metadata, client-safe exports — built for professionals, not tourists

Appendix A: Design System Direction

- Product personality: cinematic, precise, premium, production-ready
- Not: playful AI toy, comic generator, generic SaaS dashboard
- Dark workspace by default with strong contrast
- Sharp panel framing; restrained accent color
- Typography: editorial feel, not startup-template generic
- Aggressive use of whitespace around panels and controls
- Continuity status visible everywhere: locked / at risk / changed by regen

Appendix B: Key Screen Specs

Project Creation

Set constraints early. Fields: project name, screenplay upload/paste, style selection (once), genre preset, output mode (rough / polished). Style is chosen here and not scattered throughout the workspace.

Workspace (Three-Pane)

Left pane: script/scenes + parse health + confidence. Center pane: beat/shot plan + rationale + approval state + override controls. Right pane: storyboard panels + continuity badges + variant compare + regen controls + pinned anchors.

Panel Inspector

Side panel on click: source scene, source beat, shot type, camera angle, purpose, approval status, continuity notes, grounding card references, style profile, regen controls, change-shot-type control, variant history, what changed on last regen.

Export Screen

Presentation prep, not file-download punishment. Controls: PDF layout, title page toggle, panel density, notes on/off, branding/theme selection, client-safe clean mode. Export is where the product becomes worth money.

Appendix C: Terminology Standardization

Use these terms consistently throughout the product and documentation:

Use This	Not This
Approved shot plan	Generated shot list
Project-level style lock	Style selection
Local, non-destructive revision	Panel editing
Continuity state	Style consistency
Parse confidence	Script processing
Client-safe export	PDF download
Render from approved plan	Generate storyboard panels
Storyboard workspace	AI storyboard generator
Directorial workflow	AI art tool